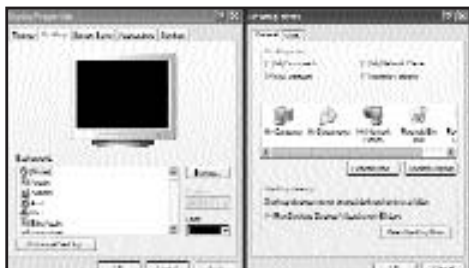


tab and click the 'Customize Desktop' button. Now under the header 'Desktop icons', you will see checkboxes for the following icons: My Documents, My

Network Places, My Computer and Internet Explorer. Check the ones you want to see on your desktop and then click 'OK'.



Choose what you see on your Desktop

Themes

If you want to try out different themes to give your desktop a different feel, right-click on the Desktop and select 'Properties' to get back to the 'Display Properties' dialog box. There is a tab called 'Themes' that contains two themes by default—Windows XP and Windows Classic. Windows XP is the default theme that is loaded when you install XP, but you can make your desktop look like Windows 98 or Windows 2000 by selecting the Windows Classic theme. This results in a more plain-looking Desktop that will probably not please too many people looking to enhance and customise their Desktops. However, it does improve performance, but more on this in the chapter on Tweaking Windows XP (Chapter 8).



Choose your XP theme

If you install themes by third parties, you will find them here, and should be able to select them.

Wallpapers

Perhaps the easiest way to modify the look of your Desktop is to change the wallpaper. Most people never graduate from the default "Bliss" wallpaper of Windows XP, which results in many similar-